

Islam & Morality

↳ After having faith, the most important thing is purifying one's character.

↳ This means a person should improve their behaviour in two ways:

1. Towards Allah:

By worshipping him sincerely, following his commands, and avoiding what he has forbidden.

2. Towards People:

By treating others with kindness, honesty, and justice.

↳ When a person does this, their actions are called righteous deeds

↳ While shariah may have changed over time, the core of religion — faith and righteous actions — has always remained the same.

↳ The Quran clearly states on Day of judgement, those who have both true faith & good deeds will be rewarded with paradise.

And he who comes before Him as a believer having done righteous deeds, exalted ranks are for such people, evergreen gardens beneath which streams flow and they shall abide therein forever. This shall be the reward of those who purify themselves. (20:75-76)

Importance of good morals:

↳ The prophet (sws) said:

He has been sent to achieve the culmination of high moral standards. The best among you are those who are morally sound from others. These are the people who are very dear to him.

On the Day of Judgement, A person's good character will be among the heaviest things on their scale of deeds.

A person can reach the same rank through high moral behaviour as can be achieved through fasts and night prayers.

What is the means through which a person can know what good and evil is?

↳ A person can know what is good and evil through 4 main sources:

1. Fitrah (Natural Disposition):

↳ Allah has created every human with an inner sense of right and wrong. This is called fitrah, which is our natural inclination towards goodness, truth, and morality.

2. Quran and Hadith:

↳ While our fitrah give us a basic idea about morality but it can be corrupted by the society. That is why Allah has sent Quran & teachings of the Rasool.

3. Intellect:

↳ Allah has given humans the ability to think. With proper guidance, intellect can help.

4. Consensus of people:

↳ The agreement of scholars and righteous individuals based on Quran and Sunnah can help.

What is the real motive which impels the person to do good?
What is the real objective behind this effort?

1. Seeking Allah's Pleasure:

↳ A believer strives to have good character because they want to please Allah.

2. Desire for paradise

↳ As above discussed.

And the soul bears witness and the perfection given to it, then [God] inspired it with its evil and its good that he succeeded who purified it and he failed who corrupted it. (91:7-10)

↳ Allah has created the soul in a perfectly balanced way, with the ability to recognize both good and evil.

↳ He has placed moral awareness in every human being, so we can differentiate b/w right & wrong.

↳ The one who purifies his soul will be successful. The one who corrupts their soul will fail.

↳ This shows true success in life is purification of heart & actions.

In fact, [in reality] man himself is a witness upon his own self however much he may put up excuses. (75:14-15)

↳ On Day of Judgement, A person cannot deceive Allah.

↳ Even though people justify their wrong actions, deep down, they know when they are doing something wrong.

↳ The human conscience serves as a witness against itself.

Importance of intentions:

- The First to Be Judged on the Day of Judgment are:

- Scholars of the Qur'an
- Those who were martyred in jihad
- Those blessed with wealth by Allah

- They will be brought before Allah, and He will remind them of His favors upon them.

- They will acknowledge these blessings, after which Allah will ask:

- "How did you use these blessings?"

- **Their Responses**

- The Scholar will say:

- "I acquired knowledge, taught others, and recited the Qur'an to call people towards You."

- The Soldier (Martyr) will say:

- "I fought for Your cause and was martyred."

- The Wealthy Person will say:

- "I spent my wealth whenever and wherever You were pleased."

- **Allah's Verdict**

- Allah will say to them:
 - "You did all of this so that people would call you a scholar, a brave person, and a generous person. And indeed, you were given those titles in the world."
 - Since their intentions were not sincere, Allah will command that they be dragged face-first into Hellfire.

Rewards for righteous believers:

O you whose heart remained content [with his Lord in times of comfort and distress]! Return unto your Lord, such that He is pleased with you and you are pleased with Him. [Return] and enter among My servants and enter My Paradise. (89:27-30)

Fundamental Principles of Islam:

↳ Allah commands three key virtues:

1. Justice: Being fair and giving everyone their due rights.

2. Goodness:

↳ Treating others better than they expect. Doing acts of kindness, generosity and mercy.

↳ Once Prophet (sws) was asked, "What is goodness?", He replied

↳ "Ihsan is you worship Allah as if you see him, and if you

cannot see him, know that He sees you."

↳ In case of interaction with humans, one should behave as if they are standing before Allah.

3. Spending on kindred: Supporting relatives and family members, ensuring their well being.

↳ Allah forbids three harmful qualities:

1. Lewdness: All forms of indecency, shamelessness, and sinful acts.

2. Evil: Anything that is wrong as considered by humans or forbidden in Islam. They can be stopped

a. By hand → Stop the individuals. Done by state

b. By tongue → Raise your voice against them. Done by Ulama

c. By wishing it in heart → Weakest form of resistance. Done by an individual.

3. Arrogance → Towards Allah & man

Moral standards:

- **Serve only Allah:** Worship none but Allah; otherwise, you will be blameworthy and disgraced on the Day of Judgment.
- **Respect your parents:** Treat them kindly, especially when they grow old. Speak to them with humility and tenderness, asking Allah for mercy on them.
- **Give to the needy:** Provide for your close relatives, the poor, and travelers.
- **Avoid wastefulness:** Do not squander your wealth. The wasteful are brothers of Satan, who is ungrateful to Allah.
- **Be moderate in spending:** Do not be miserly or overly extravagant. Allah provides to whom He pleases.
- **Do not kill your children:** Do not kill your children out of fear of poverty. Allah provides for both them and you.
- **Avoid adultery:** It is a clear sin and a wicked path.
- **Do not kill unjustly:** Do not take a life that Allah has made sacred. Killing is allowed if a person is killed unjustly or a person creates disorder, then they can be killed by the state in following exemplary ways:
 - Hanging them in public
 - Cutting their hands and legs
 - Crucifying them

‣ Exiling them from the land

- **Be just with orphans' wealth:** Do not approach the wealth of orphans except justly, until they reach maturity.
- **Keep your promises:** You will be held accountable for the promises you make.
- **Be honest in measurements:** Give full measure and use correct scales. This is better and fairer in the long term.
- **Avoid ignorance and harmful curiosity:** Do not pursue what you do not know. All your senses (eyes, ears, and heart) will be questioned.
- **Avoid arrogance:** Do not walk arrogantly on Earth; you cannot rival Allah's creation (e.g., the mountains).
- **Reaffirm the oneness of Allah:** Worship only Allah, lest you be cast into Hell

Highest moral values:

Men and women who are Muslims, are true believers, serve God diligently, are sincere, patient, humble themselves before God, spend in charity, who fast and guard their private parts and remember God in abundance – on them God will bestow forgiveness and has prepared for them a great reward. (33:35)

- **Islam:** Submitting to the will of Allah.
- **Iman:** This refers to belief in Allah, angels, books of Allah, the prophets, the Day of Judgment.
- **Humbling oneself before god.**
- **Veracity:** This means being truthful
- **Patience:** The ability to remain steadfast in face of difficulties.
- **Humility in Prayers:** Complete attentiveness, reverence, and submission during worship.
- **Zakat.**
- **Fasting.**
- **Remembering Allah in abundance.**